

Chapter 3

Making innovation happen

Innovation is more than a great idea—innovation succeeds only when you put that idea into action. The innovative manager needs the ability to find and select good ideas, put them into operation, and persuade users to adopt them.

Moving toward innovation

You can look at innovation as a journey: from the spark of a new idea to seeing that idea realized in the form of a new product, service, or workflow. You could get lucky with it once, but if you are going to repeat it, you need to put in place a systematic process to make it happen consistently.



TIP

BUILD A ROADMAP FOR THE JOURNEY

Mapping out how you will take the idea ahead helps identify potential problems and who or what else you will need to help deal with them.

Finding and selecting ideas

The journey starts with a trigger signal—a bright idea, a customer need, catching up with a competitor. Whatever the stimulus, the challenge in managing your innovation process at this stage is to make sure you have in place ways of searching for and picking up the signals. But you can't do everything—you need to be able to answer the question: "Of all the things we could do, what are we going to do, and why?" You need to select—to make choices based on where you are trying to get to as an organization and how the proposed innovation might help you get there.